ASSEM MERZOUG

IT Support / Junior Systems Administrator

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PROFILE

Systems-minded engineer moving into IT support and administration. I build, break and repair my own lab machines —Linux and Windows —and I write down what I changed and why. Comfortable at a terminal, methodical with tickets, and used to explaining a technical problem to someone who does not want the details.

SKILLS

Systems. Linux (Debian/Ubuntu/Kali) administration, Windows Server 2022 and Windows 11, Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, SMB.

Networking. TCP/IP, routing, DNS, HTTP/HTTPS, packet capture with Wireshark, service discovery with Nmap.

Automation. Python, Bash and PowerShell scripting; Vagrant and VirtualBox for reproducible machines; Git for versioning changes.

Security. Hardening basics —least privilege, service accounts, SSH key management, log review —learned by exploiting the mistakes in the field.

SELECTED WORK

Active Directory home lab

A two-machine domain (Windows Server 2022 domain controller, Windows 11 client) defined as code with Vagrant and PowerShell provisioning: forest creation, OUs, users and groups, SMB shares, and the common misconfigurations I test against.

Fifteen HackTheBox machines

Linux and Windows hosts taken from an unauthenticated start to root or Domain Admin, and documented as reports —the same troubleshooting loop a support role runs, with the evidence attached.

pdfsmith —report automation

A Python tool that produces formatted PDFs from structured data. Written to remove a repetitive manual step and keep output consistent.

EXPERIENCE

Freelance —self-employed · 2021 to present

Five years of independent client work (IT-related from the start, security-focused since 2023) run alongside the degree: agreeing what the client actually needs, delivering it, and leaving written notes so the next person can pick it up.

EDUCATION

BSc Electrical Engineering

Systems, signals and control —the theory behind the networks and automation I work with day to day.

MSc Automation & Systems Engineering —University of Palermo

In progress.

CERTIFICATIONS IN PROGRESS

BSCP and CWES in progress, studied alongside the Active Directory and Linux lab work described above.